

SORTING ALGORITHM TIME COMPARISON

Bubble Sort | Selection Sort | Insertion Sort | Merge Sort | Quick Sort

DAA Practical Experiment

Experiment	Runtime comparison of sorting algorithms
Input sizes	1000, 2000, 5000, 7000, 10000
Timing method	C clock() and CLOCKS_PER_SEC
Graphing	Python + Matplotlib
Heap Sort	Excluded as requested

This report contains the complete C benchmarking program, the complete Python graphing program, the recorded terminal output, and the generated comparison graph.

1. Experiment Overview

The C program generates one random input array for each input size, copies that same input into separate arrays, runs each sorting algorithm, measures only the sorting portion with `clock()`, prints the measured times, and writes the results to `sorting_times.csv`.

The Python program reads `sorting_times.csv` with `csv.DictReader` and plots all five algorithms against input size. The source uses the same labels and columns that appear in the CSV file.

Algorithm	Typical / Average Complexity	Measured in this run
Bubble Sort	$O(n^2)$	0.002, 0.008, 0.037, 0.064, 0.180 s
Selection Sort	$O(n^2)$	0.001, 0.001, 0.011, 0.026, 0.063 s
Insertion Sort	$O(n^2)$ average	0.000, 0.002, 0.010, 0.020, 0.069 s
Merge Sort	$O(n \log n)$	0.001, 0.001, 0.002, 0.004, 0.004 s
Quick Sort	$O(n \log n)$ average	0.000, 0.000, 0.000, 0.000, 0.002 s

Observed values above are transcribed from the supplied terminal screenshot. Tiny values such as 0.000000 are limited by the timer resolution and should not be interpreted as literally zero computation.

2. Complete C Benchmarking Code

Complete source code from the uploaded file, shown with line numbers for easier reference.

```
1  #include <stdio.h>
2  #include <stdlib.h>
3  #include <time.h>
4
5  /* ----- BUBBLE SORT ----- */
6
7  void bubbleSort(int arr[], int size)
8  {
9      for (int i = 0; i < size - 1; i++)
10     {
11         for (int j = 0; j < size - i - 1; j++)
12         {
13             if (arr[j] > arr[j + 1])
14             {
15                 int temp = arr[j];
16                 arr[j] = arr[j + 1];
17                 arr[j + 1] = temp;
18             }
19         }
20     }
21 }
22
23 /* ----- SELECTION SORT ----- */
24
25 void selectionSort(int arr[], int size)
26 {
27     for (int i = 0; i < size - 1; i++)
28     {
29         int minIndex = i;
30
31         for (int j = i + 1; j < size; j++)
32         {
33             if (arr[j] < arr[minIndex])
34             {
35                 minIndex = j;
36             }
37         }
38
39         int temp = arr[i];
40         arr[i] = arr[minIndex];
41         arr[minIndex] = temp;
42     }
43 }
44
45 /* ----- INSERTION SORT ----- */
46
47 void insertionSort(int arr[], int size)
48 {
49     for (int i = 1; i < size; i++)
50     {
51         int key = arr[i];
52         int j = i - 1;
53
54         while (j >= 0 && arr[j] > key)
55         {
56             arr[j + 1] = arr[j];
57             j--;
58         }
59
60         arr[j + 1] = key;
```

2. Complete C Benchmarking Code - continued

```
61     }
62 }
63
64 /* ----- MERGE SORT ----- */
65
66 void merge(int arr[], int left, int mid, int right)
67 {
68     int n1 = mid - left + 1;
69     int n2 = right - mid;
70
71     int *L = malloc(n1 * sizeof(int));
72     int *R = malloc(n2 * sizeof(int));
73
74     for (int i = 0; i < n1; i++)
75     {
76         L[i] = arr[left + i];
77     }
78
79     for (int i = 0; i < n2; i++)
80     {
81         R[i] = arr[mid + 1 + i];
82     }
83
84     int i = 0;
85     int j = 0;
86     int k = left;
87
88     while (i < n1 && j < n2)
89     {
90         if (L[i] <= R[j])
91         {
92             arr[k] = L[i];
93             i++;
94         }
95         else
96         {
97             arr[k] = R[j];
98             j++;
99         }
100
101         k++;
102     }
103
104     while (i < n1)
105     {
106         arr[k] = L[i];
107         i++;
108         k++;
109     }
110
111     while (j < n2)
112     {
113         arr[k] = R[j];
114         j++;
115         k++;
116     }
117
118     free(L);
119     free(R);
120 }
```

2. Complete C Benchmarking Code - continued

```
121
122 void mergeSort(int arr[], int left, int right)
123 {
124     if (left < right)
125     {
126         int mid = left + (right - left) / 2;
127
128         mergeSort(arr, left, mid);
129         mergeSort(arr, mid + 1, right);
130
131         merge(arr, left, mid, right);
132     }
133 }
134
135 /* ----- QUICK SORT ----- */
136
137 int partition(int arr[], int low, int high)
138 {
139     int pivot = arr[high];
140
141     int i = low - 1;
142
143     for (int j = low; j < high; j++)
144     {
145         if (arr[j] < pivot)
146         {
147             i++;
148
149             int temp = arr[i];
150             arr[i] = arr[j];
151             arr[j] = temp;
152         }
153     }
154
155     int temp = arr[i + 1];
156     arr[i + 1] = arr[high];
157     arr[high] = temp;
158
159     return i + 1;
160 }
161
162 void quickSort(int arr[], int low, int high)
163 {
164     if (low < high)
165     {
166         int pi = partition(arr, low, high);
167
168         quickSort(arr, low, pi - 1);
169         quickSort(arr, pi + 1, high);
170     }
171 }
172
173 /* ----- COPY ARRAY ----- */
174
175 void copyArray(int source[], int destination[], int size)
176 {
177     for (int i = 0; i < size; i++)
178     {
179         destination[i] = source[i];
180     }
181 }
```

2. Complete C Benchmarking Code - continued

```
181 }
182
183 /* ----- MAIN ----- */
184
185 int main()
186 {
187     /*
188      * Different input sizes.
189      * These are deliberately kept reasonable because
190      * Bubble, Selection and Insertion become slow as n grows.
191      */
192
193     int sizes[] = {1000, 2000, 5000, 7000, 10000};
194
195     int numberOfSizes = 5;
196
197     FILE *file = fopen("sorting_times.csv", "w");
198
199     if (file == NULL)
200     {
201         printf("Could not create CSV file.\n");
202         return 1;
203     }
204
205     fprintf(file, "Size,Bubble,Selection,Insertion,Merge,Quick\n");
206
207     srand(time(NULL));
208
209     for (int s = 0; s < numberOfSizes; s++)
210     {
211         int size = sizes[s];
212
213         printf("\nTesting size = %d\n", size);
214
215         int *original = malloc(size * sizeof(int));
216         int *arr1 = malloc(size * sizeof(int));
217         int *arr2 = malloc(size * sizeof(int));
218         int *arr3 = malloc(size * sizeof(int));
219         int *arr4 = malloc(size * sizeof(int));
220         int *arr5 = malloc(size * sizeof(int));
221
222         if (original == NULL || arr1 == NULL || arr2 == NULL ||
223             arr3 == NULL || arr4 == NULL || arr5 == NULL)
224         {
225             printf("Memory allocation failed.\n");
226
227             free(original);
228             free(arr1);
229             free(arr2);
230             free(arr3);
231             free(arr4);
232             free(arr5);
233
234             fclose(file);
235             return 1;
236         }
237
238         /* Generate same random input for all algorithms */
239
240         for (int i = 0; i < size; i++)
```

2. Complete C Benchmarking Code - continued

```
241     {
242         original[i] = rand() % 1000000;
243     }
244
245     /* ----- BUBBLE ----- */
246
247     copyArray(original, arr1, size);
248
249     clock_t start = clock();
250
251     bubbleSort(arr1, size);
252
253     clock_t end = clock();
254
255     double bubbleTime =
256         (double)(end - start) / CLOCKS_PER_SEC;
257
258     /* ----- SELECTION ----- */
259
260     copyArray(original, arr2, size);
261
262     start = clock();
263
264     selectionSort(arr2, size);
265
266     end = clock();
267
268     double selectionTime =
269         (double)(end - start) / CLOCKS_PER_SEC;
270
271     /* ----- INSERTION ----- */
272
273     copyArray(original, arr3, size);
274
275     start = clock();
276
277     insertionSort(arr3, size);
278
279     end = clock();
280
281     double insertionTime =
282         (double)(end - start) / CLOCKS_PER_SEC;
283
284     /* ----- MERGE ----- */
285
286     copyArray(original, arr4, size);
287
288     start = clock();
289
290     mergeSort(arr4, 0, size - 1);
291
292     end = clock();
293
294     double mergeTime =
295         (double)(end - start) / CLOCKS_PER_SEC;
296
297     /* ----- QUICK ----- */
298
299     copyArray(original, arr5, size);
300
```

2. Complete C Benchmarking Code - continued

```
301     start = clock();
302
303     quickSort(arr5, 0, size - 1);
304
305     end = clock();
306
307     double quickTime =
308         (double)(end - start) / CLOCKS_PER_SEC;
309
310     /* Print results */
311
312     printf("Bubble      : %f seconds\n", bubbleTime);
313     printf("Selection : %f seconds\n", selectionTime);
314     printf("Insertion : %f seconds\n", insertionTime);
315     printf("Merge      : %f seconds\n", mergeTime);
316     printf("Quick      : %f seconds\n", quickTime);
317
318     /* Save to CSV */
319
320     fprintf(file, "%d,%f,%f,%f,%f,%f\n",
321             size,
322             bubbleTime,
323             selectionTime,
324             insertionTime,
325             mergeTime,
326             quickTime);
327
328     free(original);
329     free(arr1);
330     free(arr2);
331     free(arr3);
332     free(arr4);
333     free(arr5);
334 }
335
336 fclose(file);
337
338 printf("\nResults saved to sorting_times.csv\n");
339
340 return 0;
341 }
```


3. Complete Python Graphing Code

Complete source code from the uploaded file, shown with line numbers for easier reference.

```
1  import csv
2  import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
3
4  sizes = []
5
6  bubble = []
7  selection = []
8  insertion = []
9  merge = []
10 quick = []
11
12 with open("sorting_times.csv", "r") as file:
13
14     reader = csv.DictReader(file)
15
16     for row in reader:
17
18         sizes.append(int(row["Size"]))
19
20         bubble.append(float(row["Bubble"]))
21         selection.append(float(row["Selection"]))
22         insertion.append(float(row["Insertion"]))
23         merge.append(float(row["Merge"]))
24         quick.append(float(row["Quick"]))
25
26
27 plt.plot(sizes, bubble, marker='o', label="Bubble Sort")
28 plt.plot(sizes, selection, marker='o', label="Selection Sort")
29 plt.plot(sizes, insertion, marker='o', label="Insertion Sort")
30 plt.plot(sizes, merge, marker='o', label="Merge Sort")
31 plt.plot(sizes, quick, marker='o', label="Quick Sort")
32
33 plt.xlabel("Input Size")
34 plt.ylabel("Time (seconds)")
35
36 plt.title("Sorting Algorithm Time Comparison")
37
38 plt.legend()
39
40 plt.grid(True)
41
42 plt.show()
```

4. Program Output Screenshot

This is the supplied VS Code / PowerShell output produced by the C benchmarking program.

```
PS C:\Users\sahil\OneDrive\Dokumen\DAA_programs> cd 'c:\Users\sahil\OneDrive\Dokumen\DAA_programs\output'
PS C:\Users\sahil\OneDrive\Dokumen\DAA_programs\output> & .\'time_comparison_sorting.exe'

Testing size = 1000
Bubble   : 0.002000 seconds
Selection : 0.001000 seconds
Insertion : 0.000000 seconds
Merge    : 0.001000 seconds
Quick    : 0.000000 seconds

Testing size = 2000
Bubble   : 0.008000 seconds
Selection : 0.001000 seconds
Insertion : 0.002000 seconds
Merge    : 0.001000 seconds
Quick    : 0.000000 seconds

Testing size = 5000
Bubble   : 0.037000 seconds
Selection : 0.011000 seconds
Insertion : 0.010000 seconds
Merge    : 0.002000 seconds
Quick    : 0.000000 seconds

Testing size = 7000
Bubble   : 0.064000 seconds
Selection : 0.026000 seconds
Insertion : 0.020000 seconds
Merge    : 0.004000 seconds
Quick    : 0.000000 seconds

Testing size = 10000
Bubble   : 0.180000 seconds
Selection : 0.063000 seconds
Insertion : 0.069000 seconds
Merge    : 0.004000 seconds
Quick    : 0.002000 seconds
```

Figure 1. Terminal output showing measured times for all five sorting algorithms.

5. Sorting Time Comparison Graph

The supplied graph plots input size on the x-axis and measured execution time in seconds on the y-axis. The three quadratic algorithms rise more rapidly than Merge Sort and Quick Sort in the shown experiment.

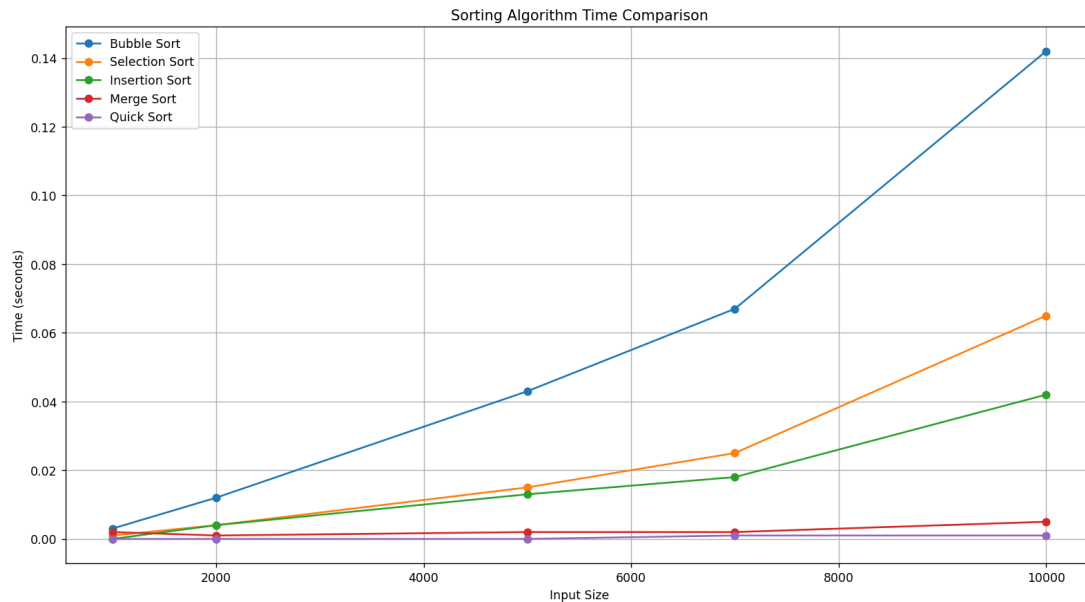


Figure 2. Sorting Algorithm Time Comparison generated with Python and Matplotlib.

6. Result and Conclusion

For the measured input sizes, Bubble Sort shows the largest increase in runtime. Selection Sort and Insertion Sort also grow substantially as the input increases. Merge Sort and Quick Sort remain much faster in the supplied run, which is consistent with their lower average asymptotic growth rates.

The exact timings are machine-dependent. The experiment is therefore most useful for observing the overall growth trend, rather than treating one individual timing value as universal.

The attached source files are preserved in the report as provided for the experiment: the C program benchmarks the five sorting algorithms and writes `sorting_times.csv`, while the Python program reads that CSV and creates the comparison graph.

Observed timing values from the supplied terminal screenshot (seconds):

Input Size	Bubble	Selection	Insertion	Merge	Quick
1000	0.002	0.001	0.000	0.001	0.000
2000	0.008	0.001	0.002	0.001	0.000
5000	0.037	0.011	0.010	0.002	0.000
7000	0.064	0.026	0.020	0.004	0.000
10000	0.180	0.063	0.069	0.004	0.002